

MAXIME ROCHE

Economics of Food, Nutrition, Agriculture, and the Environment
Centre for Health Economics & Policy Innovation
Department of Economics & Public Policy
Imperial College London

PERSONAL DATA

NATIONALITY AND YEAR OF BIRTH: French | 1993
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WEBSITE: <https://www.maximeroche.com>

EDUCATION

SEP 2022 - PhD Candidate in ECONOMICS & PUBLIC POLICY, **Imperial College London** – UK
Expected completion: AUG 2026
Advisors: Prof. Franco SASSI, Dr. Laure DE PREUX

2021-2022 Awarded **Distinction** for MRes in ECONOMICS, **Imperial College London** – UK

2017-2018 Master of Sc. in ECONOMICS, **University of Amsterdam** – Netherlands

2013-2017 Master of Sc. in CORPORATE FINANCE & BANKING, **EDHEC Business School**
Master in MANAGEMENT, **EDHEC Business School**
Bachelor's degree in BUSINESS MANAGEMENT, **EDHEC Business School** – France

2011-2013 Preparatory classes in MATHEMATICS & PHYSICS for the entrance exams to top French engineer & business schools, **Lycee Joffre (Montpellier)** – France

VISITING

SPRING 2025 Visiting researcher, hosted by DR. ARIEL ORTIZ BOBEA, Dyson School of Applied Economics & Management at **Cornell University** – NY, USA

SPRING 2016 Exchange semester in Master in ECONOMICS & PUBLIC POLICY at **Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez** – Chile

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Food Policy, Health Economics, Agricultural Economics, Environmental Economics

PEER-REVIEWED ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

- [Can differentiated value-added tax rates promote healthier diets? The case of Costa Rica](#) (*Food Policy*, 2025)

WORKING PAPERS

- [How is climate fuelling the thirst for sweetness? Exploring drivers and adaptation](#), *Chicago Booth Kilts Center for Marketing Data Center Paper Series*, with Laure de Preux (ICL)

- [Taxation of foods high in fat, sugar, and sodium in India: A modelling study of health and economic impacts](#), R&R at *PLOS Medicine*, with Jingmin Zhu (ICL), Jack Olney (ICL), Daniel J Laydon (ICL), William Joe (IEG), Manika Sharma (RTSL), Lindsay Steele (RTSL), & Franco Sassi (ICL)

WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Theory-Based Predictions and the Future of Food Demand: A Global Meta-Analysis of Demand Elasticities**, with Andrew Comstock (IFPRI) & Olivier Ecker (IFPRI)
- **Unpacking the impact of extreme heat on undernutrition: Evidence from panel data in five Sub-Saharan African countries**, solo-authored

SELECTED PEER-REVIEWED POLICY PUBLICATIONS

- [Comparing taxes as a percentage of sugar-sweetened beverage prices in Latin America and the Caribbean](#) (*The Lancet Regional Health - Americas*, 2023)
AUTHORS: **Maxime Roche (ICL)**, Miriam Alvarado (Cambridge), Rosa Sandoval (PAHO), Fabio da Silva Gomes (PAHO), Guillermo Paraje (UAI)
- [Comparing taxes on alcoholic beverages in the Region of the Americas](#) (*Addiction*, 2023)
AUTHORS: **Maxime Roche (ICL)**, Rosa Sandoval (PAHO), Maristela Monteiro (PAHO)

POLICY BOOK CHAPTERS

- [United Nations. Handbook on Health Taxes for Developing Countries](#). Chapter 13: Specific Issues with respect to Taxation to Support Improved Nutrition (*accepted, forthcoming 2026*).
AUTHORS: Anne-Marie Thow (U Sidney), **Maxime Roche (ICL)**, Libby Hattersley (World Bank), Kate Mandeville (World Bank)
- [United Nations. Handbook on Health Taxes for Developing Countries](#). Chapter 9: Interaction between Health Taxes and other Instruments (*accepted, forthcoming 2026*).
AUTHORS: Franco Sassi (ICL), **Maxime Roche (ICL)**
- [World Health Organization. Health taxes: Policy and practice](#). Chapter 10: Monitoring and measuring health taxes (*World Scientific*, 2023)
AUTHORS: Rosa Sandoval (PAHO), **Maxime Roche (ICL)**, Anne-Marie Perucic (WHO), Itziar Belausteguigoitia (WHO), Miriam Alvarado (Cambridge), Luis Galicia (MoH URY), Guillermo Paraje (UAI)

ACADEMIC CONFERENCES & SEMINARS

2025 American Economic Association annual meeting (ASSA, *Invited to present*); European Association of Agricultural Economists (EAAE, *Invited to present*) congress; Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE) summer conference (*Presentation*); Potsdam Institute for Climate Impact Research (PIK)'s DENEb PhD Workshop (*Invited to present*); Columbia University's Interdisciplinary PhD Workshop in Sustainable Development (*Presentation*); University of Costa Rica's School of Economics (*Presentation*)

2024 Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) (*Presentation*); Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE) (*Presentation*); European Health Economics Association (EuHEA) (*Presentation*); Canadian Economics Association (CEA) (*Presentation*); French Economists Association (AFSE) (*Presentation*); Maastricht University's Workshop on Applied Economics of the Environment (*Presentation*); University of Goettingen's Sustainable Food Systems Symposium (*Presentation*); Imperial College London's Economics & Public Policy (*Presentation*)

2023 International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI) ‘Delivering for Nutrition in South Asia’ (*Presentation*); University of Warwick ‘Quantitative Methods in Social Sciences’ (*Presentation*); University of Birmingham’s Health Economics Unit (*Presentation*); University of Costa Rica’s School of Nutrition (*Presentation*); Imperial College London’s Centre for Health Economics & Policy Innovation (*Presentation*); Imperial College London’s Public Health Policy Evaluation Unit (*Presentation*)

INVITED REFEREE

JOURNALS Applied Economics; Food Policy; Climatic Change; PLOS One; The Lancet Public Health
 CONFERENCES EAAE 2025; EAYE 2025; EuHEA 2024

OTHER PARTICIPATIONS & CONTRIBUTIONS

MEMBERSHIPS AAEA; AEA; AERE; EAAE; United Nations’ Subcommittee on Health Taxes
 COURSES University of Copenhagen’s Department of Food and Resource Economics
 ‘International PhD course: Food and health policy analysis using
 home-scan data’ (Copenhagen, Denmark, Dec 2023);
 BREAD-IGC ‘Virtual PhD course on Environmental Economics’
 OTHER Global Fellows Programme: ‘Data for sustainability’ - NTU Singapore (2023);
 United Nations’ Subcommittee on Health Taxes meeting (Geneva, 2025)

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

2021-2025 London Interdisciplinary Social Science Doctoral Training Partnership,
UK Economic and Social Research Council
 4-year: Full tuition + Full-time stipend allowance + Research & Training funds
 2025 Imperial College London’s Global Fellows Fund **Turing Scheme grant**
 Overseas research funding ≈ GBP 1,700

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

FEB 2025 - present Research assistant, Foresight & Policy Modeling Unit
International Food Policy Research Institute, Washington DC (remote)
 JUN 2023 - MAR 2024 Research assistant, CHEPI
Imperial College London, London
 APR 2022 - JUL 2023 Consultant, Fiscal Policies for Health team
World Health Organization, Geneva (remote)
 MAR 2019 - AUG 2021 Consultant, Risk Factors & Nutrition Unit,
 Economics of Noncommunicable Diseases team
Pan American Health Organization, Washington DC
 DEC 2018 - MAR 2019 Consultant, Health, Nutrition & Population Global Practice,
World Bank, Washington DC
 SEP 2015 - FEB 2016 Intern, Financial audit
KPMG, Paris

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

FALL 2024 & 2025	Tutorial leader, MICROECONOMICS 2 BSc Economics, Finance & Data Science; Imperial College London Course leader: Prof. Tommaso Valletti (<i>t.valletti@imperial.ac.uk</i>)
FALL 2024	Teaching Assistant, HEALTH ECONOMICS MSc Global Health Management; Imperial College London Course leader: Prof. Marisa Miraldo (<i>m.miraldo@imperial.ac.uk</i>)
ACADEMIC YEAR 2017-2018	Teacher, MATHEMATICS FOR ECONOMICS & FINANCE University of Amsterdam, ONCAMPUS Cambridge Education Course leader: Evgenia Papoula (<i>epapoula@oncampus.global</i>)

LANGUAGES

FRENCH: Mothertongue
ENGLISH: Fluent
SPANISH: Fluent

COMPUTER SKILLS

Advanced Knowledge: STATA, Python, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Microsoft Office Suite
Working Knowledge: VBA, Tableau

ACADEMIC REFERENCES

Professor Franco Sassi	Imperial College London	<i>f.sassi@imperial.ac.uk</i>
Dr Laure de Preux	Imperial College London	<i>l.depreux@imperial.ac.uk</i>
Dr Olivier Ecker	International Food Policy Research Institute	<i>o.ecker@cgiar.org</i>

PROFESSIONAL REFERENCES

Rosa Sandoval	Pan American Health Organization	<i>sandovar@paho.org</i>
Dr Anselm Hennis	Pan American Health Organization	<i>hennisa@paho.org</i>
Anne-Marie Perucic	World Health Organization	<i>perucica@who.int</i>